

Chapter 6 Test— Answer Key

Matching [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Match each item to the correct answer.

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|-------------------------------------|---|
| <u>G</u> 1. Argument | A. A mistake in reasoning that renders an argument invalid, unsound, weak, or ineffective |
| <u>E</u> 2. Assertion | B. An argument that has two premises supporting a conclusion |
| <u>F</u> 3. Critical Thinking | C. The study of orderly thinking and the principles of reasoning |
| <u>A</u> 4. Fallacy | D. A proposition cannot be both true and not true at the same time and in the same sense |
| <u>D</u> 5. Law of noncontradiction | E. A confident statement of belief that is unsupported by reasons |
| <u>C</u> 6. Logic | F. The process of analyzing and evaluating information for validity and soundness |
| <u>B</u> 7. Syllogism | G. A set of premises supporting a conclusion |

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

8. Knowing the difference between an argument and an assertion is part of . . .
 - a. attentive listening.
 - b. critical thinking.**
 - c. a false dilemma.
 - d. logic.
9. The basic function of _____ is to help us distinguish between strong and weak reasoning.
 - a. attentive listening
 - b. critical thinking
 - c. fallacies
 - d. logic**
10. A syllogism is . . .
 - a. an example of the law of noncontradiction.
 - b. a type of fallacy.
 - c. faulty reasoning.
 - d. a type of argument.**
11. In a(n) _____ argument, the conclusion must follow from the premises.
 - a. sound
 - b. valid**
 - c. *non sequitur*
 - d. deductive
 - e. inductive

12. In their communication, critical thinkers seek to be . . .
 - a. **clear.**
 - b. **accurate.**
 - c. general.
 - d. **consistent.**
 - e. **relevant.**
 - f. **complete.**

13. Which of the following is true about weighing sources?
 - a. Apologists accept the arguments from other apologists.
 - b. **Critical thinkers carefully investigate sources.**
 - c. **The best sources are generally by authors who are knowledgeable in the field relevant to the topic.**
 - d. **Free online encyclopedias and similar sources are usually inappropriate for serious arguments.**

14. A(n) _____ argument is one in which both premises are true.
 - a. logical
 - b. *tu quoque*
 - c. **sound**
 - d. inductive

15. When we learn to reason well, we . . .
 - a. **demonstrate love for God and our neighbors.**
 - b. **think critically.**
 - c. **ask good questions.**
 - d. **become better at making sound arguments.**
 - e. **help those who feel lost discover the truth.**

16. Which of the following are examples of fallacies?
 - a. **straw man**
 - b. **slippery slope**
 - c. syllogism
 - d. **hasty generalization**
 - e. **scare tactic**
 - f. **bandwagon**
 - g. using the Bible as a bludgeon
 - h. **red herring**

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

- F 17. If there are two statements that contradict each other, they are an example of syllogisms.
the law of noncontradiction
- F 18. In Colossians 2:3, Paul urged Timothy to rightly handle God's truth. 2 Timothy 2:15
- T 19. Hebrews 4:12 tells us the word of God is living and active, and sharper than any two-edged sword. _____
- T 20. In an inductive argument the conclusion is inferred from the premises. _____
- F 21. Inductive arguments take general principles and draw specific conclusions. Deductive
- T 22. In a sound argument, both premises must be true. _____
- F 23. When Jesus was here on Earth, he regularly used fallacies and logic when communicating with people. reason

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Question 27 is worth 4 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

24. Proverbs 18:13 points out the folly of giving an answer before listening.
25. Wise and loving listeners pay attention to body language, considering such things as facial expressions.
26. When the person you are listening to pauses or concludes, try to hold silence for at least five seconds before you speak.
27. A good question, when asked in a gracious manner, invites further conversation and exploration.
28. Beware of referencing Bible verses that are irrelevant to the point being made.

29. _____ **Listening** _____, asking good questions, and using Scripture with care are three ways of demonstrating wisdom and love in apologetic conversations.

30. Our goal in apologetics is to lead others to _____ **Jesus** _____.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

31. Write a syllogism that wasn't used in the student textbook.

Answers will vary but should include two premises that support a conclusion.

32. Is the syllogism you wrote above a sound argument? Is it a valid argument? Explain why or why not.

Answers will vary based on the syllogism written. If it is a sound argument, then both premises will be true. If it is a valid argument, the conclusion will follow from the premises.

33. Is the following argument a deductive or an inductive argument? Explain your answer.

Most summers in Colorado are windy.

Therefore, next summer will probably be windy.

This is an inductive argument because the conclusion is inferred from the premises, and it took specific instances and formed a general principle.

34. What type of fallacy is the following statement? Explain why.

The Bible is true because it says it is

This is a circular argument, also known as begging the question, because the arguer assumes what he or she is trying to prove.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

35. Suppose you were having a conversation with someone and mentioned that God has really blessed your family. The person you were talking to said he is an atheist and doesn't believe in God. How would you respond in a wise and loving way? Include at least five tools in your answer that you have learned from Chapter 6.

Possible answer: First I would ask him a question like who or what he means by God. While he answers, I would listen carefully, making sure I don't look at my cell phone. I would also make eye contact with him and wait to speak, making sure he is done with his response. I would not use the Bible in an inappropriate way, such as trying to shut down the person just to win the argument or taking verses out of context. I would not use any fallacies in my conversation, but I would gently ask more questions if he used a fallacy in his argument.

36. Choose three of the following fallacies and explain how each one is fallacious: *tu quoque*, straw man, scare tactic, red herring, appeal to pity, bandwagon, loaded words, and hasty generalization. **Answers must include three of the following:**

Tu quoque: defending your own error by pointing out a similar error in your

opponent **Straw man:** distorting an opponent's argument, so it is easier to attack

Scare tactic: threatening an opponent with negative consequences if he or she does

not accept the arguer's conclusion

Red herring: introducing an irrelevant issue that distracts from the main argument

Appeal to pity: attempting to persuade us to accept a conclusion by appealing to feelings of pity or sympathy that are irrelevant to the argument

Bandwagon: making an appeal to accept the conclusions of an argument because they are popular **Loaded words:** hurling an inflammatory word at your opponent's position to make it look bad **Hasty generalization:** making a large, generalized claim about an entire group on the basis of insufficient evidence

37. Explain why being able to reason well is important.

Possible answer: When we reason well, we demonstrate love for God and people. We develop our ability to make sound arguments, think critically, spot logical errors, and ask good questions. We also can treat others fairly as we explore truth with them, and we can engage wisely in the spiritual battle to see people set free in Christ. Reasoning is one tool we can use to help those who feel lost or confused when trying to discover the truth